Surveying Chain

Category: **Measuring & Marking Tools** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Chain and tape

What it is used for

A surveying chain or measuring tape measures distances for land surveying, layout, and field measurements. Use the correct measurement method and account for alignment and site conditions when recording results.

How to use

1. Inspect the chain or tape for stretched links, damaged hooks, worn markings, or kinks.
2. Identify the required distance and confirm the correct measuring unit.
3. Mark the starting and ending points clearly.
4. Align the chain or tape along the measurement line and keep it straight.
5. Apply consistent tension and avoid twists or sag where practical.
6. Read and record the measurement, repeating it if verification is required.
7. Clean the equipment, rewind or coil it carefully, and store it safely.

⚠ Safety

- Wear suitable footwear and remain aware of traffic and nearby hazards.
- Keep hands clear of sharp hooks and moving chain links.
- Do not stretch measuring equipment across active vehicle routes without approved controls.
- Avoid measuring near overhead electrical lines with conductive equipment.

Care & storage

- Wipe the chain or tape dry and store it without knots, kinks, or corrosion exposure.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.